Compare a little water

A Kitchen Sponge

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

1. Little squeezes 32 millilitres of water into one cup and 47 into another. Which symbol compares the amounts?

32 ○ 47

Show your thinking.

2. Big measures 63 millilitres of water squeezed from a sponge. What is that amount rounded to the nearest ten?

63 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

3. A sponge soaks up 58 millilitres and a cloth soaks up 51 millilitres in a test. Which symbol compares the amounts?

58 ○ 51

Show your thinking.

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4. Little counts 25 visible holes in a close-up sponge sketch. What is that count rounded to the nearest ten?

25 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

5. Little counts 76 drops in one cup and 89 in another after a squeeze. Which symbol compares the counts?

76 ○ 89

Show your thinking.

6. The measuring cup holds 97 millilitres from several sponge squeezes. What is that amount rounded to the nearest ten?

97 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

A Kitchen Sponge

A question full of holes

Little Wonderer peered through a magnifier at a kitchen sponge. A sponge is a soft material that can take in water.

Water finds a way

Big dipped the sponge into a shallow dish. Its lower edge grew darker. Water clung to the sponge's walls and crept into narrow gaps.

A squeeze into the cup

Big lifted the sponge over an empty cup. "Where is the water now?" asked Little. Big gave a gentle squeeze: a press from both sides.

Two little spills

Next they compared two same-size pieces. One was bone-dry; the other was damp, with a little water already inside.

Open again

Big let go after another squeeze. The sponge began to spring back, returning to its open shape. Its spaces opened too, ready to take in water again.

A question to keep

"Is our sponge an animal?" Little asked. "Sea sponges are simple animals," said Big.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

Give a sponge test its words

A Kitchen Sponge · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Write one clear command for the sponge test. Say your sentence first if you like.



Water finds a way



A squeeze into the cup



Open again

Draw the sponge, its holes, and the cup. Add an arrow for the water.

dip · lift · squeeze · cup · holes · water · release · notice

First, ... tell how to dip the sponge in the dish

Then, ... tell how to squeeze it over the cup

At the end, ... tell how to let go and watch the shape

Does your sentence tell what to do, with a command such as Dip, Lift, Squeeze, or Release?

A Kitchen Sponge

01 What is inside all those holes?



Tiny holes lead into connected spaces.

Look closer. The magnifier makes the sponge's open spaces easier to notice.

A little explanation. A kitchen sponge has pores: tiny holes leading into connected spaces. Water can travel through these spaces, like little tunnels. Most kitchen sponges are made by people from cellulose, a plant fibre, or foam. Many sea sponges are simple animals; this kitchen sponge is a made object.

Try this. Find two holes, then imagine a path between spaces inside.

02 How does water move into the sponge?



Water clings to the walls and creeps into narrow gaps.

Look closer. The sponge's wet edge grows darker as it touches water.

A little explanation. Water clings to the sponge's walls and creeps along narrow gaps. We call this spreading wicking. To absorb means to take water in. Some water is held inside the connected spaces, so you cannot see all of it from outside.

Try this. With Big leading, use a new, clean sponge, a tray, two clear cups, and a measuring spoon. Dip, lift, and squeeze over the empty cup. Wipe up drips so the floor stays dry.

03 Why does a squeeze bring the water back?



A squeeze makes the spaces smaller and pushes water out.

Look closer. Drops fall from the squeezed sponge into the cup.

A little explanation. Squeezing presses the sponge's walls closer together. There is less room inside, so water is pushed out. Let go, and the springy material opens back up. It can soak up water again.

Try this. Compare the sponge's shape during a squeeze and after you let go.

04 Would a damp sponge soak up a spill faster?



Same-size pieces, the same water, and the same time make a fair test.

Look closer. Two same-size pieces meet equal little spills for the same time.

A little explanation. A damp sponge often starts soaking faster than a bone-dry one. Damp means a little wet, not full of water. Compare fairly: use the same kind and size of sponge, equal amounts of water, and the same time. Look at how much of each spill is left.

Try this. Predict which spill will shrink faster, then compare what is left.